

 Challenge Name:	Once-Only Dog Tax - Code a Platform
 Problem Statement:	"In Germany's municipal administration landscape, over 11,000 municipalities independently manage dog tax registration. When a citizen relocates from one city to another (e.g., Hannover to Leverkusen), they must manually de-register their dog in the old municipality and re-register in the new one - submitting the same information twice, waiting weeks for processing each time, and causing administrative overhead. This issue leads to citizen frustration, duplicated effort, wasted administrative resources, and a gap between current practice and the EU's Once-Only Principle (legally binding since 2023), which aims to ensure that data already held by one authority should not need to be re-submitted by citizens."
 HACKATHON CHALLENGE:	"How might we use SaaS architecture, REST APIs, and automated data transfer protocols to enable seamless dog tax registration transfers between municipalities, so that citizens only need to submit their information once, while ensuring strict data isolation between municipal tenants and full audit compliance?"
 Available Data & Resources:	"Participants will have access to real German municipal dog tax regulations - they should select any two cities to discover how wildly their tax rules differ! To support their work, we supply teams with regulatory documents and guidelines as background resources. These include EU Once-Only Principle documentation and sample data structure guidance for owners and municipal tenants, providing essential context for the regulatory framework and data standards. Participants can supercharge their coding with AI assistants like GitHub Copilot, ChatGPT, or Claude. They may choose any programming language, REST framework, and database they want - SQLite is recommended for zero setup. One rule: solutions must remain local and free - no paid cloud services are allowed!"
 Success Criteria:	"A successful solution should enable information flow between municipal administrations while ensuring the strong rules for data protection and tax secrecy. A good solution enables information flow; a great solution also ensures compliance with data protection rules. The solution should include automated tax calculations that account for different regulations between municipalities, demonstrating how the same dog can be taxed differently when transferred from one city to another. The solution should include documentation and a UI that can be presented in a demo. Evaluation Metric: Solutions will be assessed on (1) enabling seamless information flow and (2) maintaining full data protection compliance - with excellence in both dimensions defining a great solution."
 Key Considerations (optional):	"When transferring dog registrations between municipalities, solutions should preserve all historical data by marking cases as de-registered rather than deleting them, maintaining a complete audit trail. Participants are strongly encouraged to leverage AI coding assistants to accelerate development and debug issues."